



<| The Forbidden City,
Ming dynasty painting

1420 FORBIDDEN CITY BUILT

China's Yongle Emperor ordered Beijing to be rebuilt from scratch as a capital for the Ming empire. At the heart of the new capital lay the Forbidden City, designed as an awe-inspiring imperial palace and seat of government. The Forbidden City was the work of more than 100,000 artisans and countless labourers. Around it, Beijing soon grew to be the world's largest city, with nearly a million residents by the 1440s according to estimates.

More than 100 million tiles and bricks were used to build Beijing's Forbidden City

1420

1422 The Vijayanagara empire of South India reaches its peak under Deva Raya II

1428 A Vietnamese revolt against Ming China ends with rebel leader Le Loi taking the throne of Dai Viet

1428 The Aztec Triple Alliance brings together three city-states to rule over the Valley of Mexico

1421 At the Battle of Kutna Hora, Hussite rebels score victory over the Holy Roman Empire

1427 Portuguese sailors reach the Azores in the mid-Atlantic

1428 Ulugh Beg, sultan of Samarkand, builds an astronomical observatory

"I was 13 when I had a voice from God..."

JOAN OF ARC, PUBLIC EXAMINATION,
FEBRUARY 1431



△ Joan of Arc window in Fougères, France

1429 SIEGE OF ORLEANS

Close to winning the Hundred Years' War, the English besieged Orléans. A peasant girl, Joan of Arc, arrived in the French camp with orders from God to revive French resistance. Inspired, the French broke the siege, a turning point in the war. Joan was executed by her enemies in 1431.